

**Guidelines for Child Care Institutions under the
Juvenile Justice (Care & Protection of Children) Act, 2015 in the Context of COVID-19¹**
24th April 2020

COVID-19 has presented different challenges for children within India's juvenile justice system. Child Care Institutions (CCIs) under the Juvenile Justice (Care and Protection of Children) Act, 2015 (JJ Act, 2015) are now required to adhere to the directions of the Hon'ble Supreme Court of India dated 03.03.20 *in re Contagion of COVID 19 Virus in Children Protection Homes*,² as well as advisories by the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, Government of India related to prevention of and response to COVID-19.

CCIs have an obligation to ensure that all children in their care are safe, and that their rights are respected, protected and fulfilled, given the obligations arising out of the Constitution of India, international treaties ratified by India and domestic laws on child protection. Children residing in these CCIs, are already vulnerable to the negative impact of being institutionalized and deprived of their liberty. For many children, a CCI offers much-needed care and protection, particularly when it is not in their best interest to continue to live with their own family/guardian/relatives. However, they are potentially at additional risk of being infected by COVID-19 owing to proximate living conditions, limited access to fresh air or water, and pre-existing vulnerabilities.³ Further, COVID-19 can "disrupt the environments in which children grow and develop"⁴ as the CCIs are now working with fewer staff and restricted entry of other service providers.

It is thus important that in the context of COVID-19, preventive and control measures must be urgently undertaken within CCIs while ensuring they are in accordance with the obligation to respect, protect and fulfill the rights of children.

Enfold Proactive Health Trust has developed these guidelines for ease of reference of staff of CCIs. The guidelines are based on the Supreme Court's directions, advisories issued by the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, Government of India, guidance by the World Health Organization (WHO) and Centre for Disease Control and Prevention (USA) on COVID-19, as well as fundamental principles under the JJ Act, 2015.

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- 1. Illustrative Application of Fundamental Principles while responding to COVID-19**
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- 5. Guidelines for Conducting Online Activities and Sessions with Children/Staff of Child Care Institutions**
- 6. Posters that can be displayed in CCIs**

¹ These Guidelines have been prepared by a multidisciplinary team comprising Arlene Manoharan, Dr. Sangeeta Saksena, and Swagata Raha from Enfold Proactive Health Trust. We are grateful to Bharti Ali - Cofounder & Executive Director of HAQ Centre for Child Rights; Govind Beniwal - former member Rajasthan State Commission for Protection of Child Rights; Ravinder Kaur Pasricha - Sr. Manager, Alternative Care & Dr. Kiran Modi - Founder & Managing Trustee from Udayan Care; and Dr. Bhavani V. from Enfold for their inputs. Enfold may be contacted at info@enfoldindia.org

² *Suo Motu Writ Petition (Civil) No.4 of 2020*, available at https://main.sci.gov.in/supremecourt/2020/10820/10820_2020_0_4_21584_Order_03-Apr-2020.pdf

³ Penal Reform International, *Coronavirus: Healthcare and human rights of people in prison*, 16 March 2020, p.2, available at <https://cdn.penalreform.org/wp-content/uploads/2020/03/FINAL-Briefing-Coronavirus.pdf>

⁴ The Alliance for Child Protection in Humanitarian Action, *Guidance Note: Protection of Children during infectious disease outbreaks*, pp 9-15, available at https://www.alliancecpa.org/en/system/tdf/library/attachments/cp_during_ido_guide_0.pdf?file=1&type=node&id=30184

Illustrative Application of Fundamental Principles while responding to COVID-19

Do's	Don'ts
Safety ● Prepare an emergency plan, reorganize and train staff on COVID-19 and implications for management of CCI, regulate entry of staff and visitors, and ensure procedures related to hygiene, cleanliness, segregation, reporting to health authorities, and other matters relating to safety are adhered to based on Government guidelines and the Supreme Court's directions dated 03.04.20. ● Continue with the regular routine maintained in the home, with minimal disruptions, so as to maintain a sense of security and wellbeing, while taking all measures to ensure the safety of the children and the staff. ● Ensure that children being released, discharged or transferred are provided with copies of relevant documents, contact numbers of persons they could call for any assistance, etc., and keep the DCPU informed, so as to prevent any harassment or distress during their journey. ● Monitor all online/telephonic interactions of family members, authorized service providers, and volunteers with the children.	● Avoid delays in facilitating access to treatment or medical intervention due to procedural requirements.
Dignity, equality, non-discrimination & non-stigmatizing semantics: ● Treat children with respect, dignity and equality, irrespective of their COVID-19 status and/or their caste, tribe religion, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, disability, place of birth, etc. ● Ensure that needs of all children, particularly children with disabilities are met. For this purpose: ● Ensure continuity of care by essential staff and caregivers; ● Ensure information provided is child-friendly and accessible to children with disabilities.	● Avoid stereotyping or blaming any group/community for the pandemic. ● Do not use language that could stigmatize children affected or infected with COVID-19 as 'COVID-19 children'. ● Do not neglect the needs of children with disabilities, children living with HIV/AIDS, pregnant girls, or children with other vulnerabilities in your care.
Best Interests & institutionalisation as a measure of last resort: ● Consider the best interest of every child, taking into account the child's age and maturity, as well as views of other staff and the Support Person in POCSO cases while recommending de-institutionalization. ● Make arrangements for children to be in telephonic contact/video calls with parents/family at least twice a week.	● Do not recommend discharge of a child unless you are confident that the child will be safe upon restoration and that adequate arrangements for the child's safety are made. ● Do not deny children access to their families or relatives (via telephone or in person) unless it is expressly prohibited by the CWC/JJB/Children's Court.
Right to be heard ● Make yourself available to children. Be open, calm, patient and approachable.	● Do not deny children an opportunity to express their views. ● Avoid depriving children of information or dismissing their questions, concerns and

• All children, including children with disabilities, may need extra attention from you and may want to talk about their concerns, fears, and questions. It is important that they know they have someone who will listen to them.⁵ • Provide children with information they need about COVID-19, in an age-appropriate and disability-sensitive manner. • Dispel myths⁶ around COVID-19. If a child asks about something and you don't know the answer, say so.⁷ • Involve children/Children's Committees in decisions concerning how the CCI may need to be re-organized and managed during this time.	fears. • Avoid creating fear or confusion among the children or sharing information that is unverified or not age-appropriate. • Avoid overloading children with information on COVID-19. • Do not prevent children from voicing their opinions or views. Avoid being judgmental or dismissive of children's views or labelling them.
Positive measures: • Explore children's contact with authorized service providers through audio-visual means to maintain connection with the outside world and continuity of psycho-social support and learning. • Proactively seek support from civil society and community members for arranging laptops, dongles, art-craft materials, etc.,; sanitize them, and make time to facilitate regular interaction. • Call for online/telephonic meetings with NGOs/individuals permitted to work in the CCI, to plan how they can continue to provide support and services.	• Avoid blaming any person or system for any lack of resources or connectivity. • Do not leave the children unsupervised during online interactions. • Do not allow any recording of children during online interactions.
Privacy and confidentiality • Maintain children's right to privacy and confidentiality while communicating information about children who may have been exposed to/infected/affected by COVID-19. • Seek the permission of the JJB/CWC/Children's Court permission before disclosing information about the child's status to anyone other than medical professionals. • Ensure that medical records of children who are being transferred to other districts or repatriated are sent in sealed envelopes.	• Do not disclose the identity of any child in the CCI to the media. • Do not share information about a child's COVID-19 status, with anyone except other CCI staff, the CWC/JJB/Children's Court, parent or guardian of the child, and medical professionals.

⁵ Adapted from Ministry of Women and Child Development, "Coping Strategy for Children and Caregivers", 480884/2020/JS WCD, available at <https://wcd.nic.in/sites/default/files/FINAL%20COPING%20STRATEGY.pdf>

⁶ See World Health Organization, Coronavirus disease (COVID-19) advice for the public: Myth busters, available at <https://www.who.int/emergencies/diseases/novel-coronavirus-2019/advice-for-public/myth-busters>

⁷ Adapted from Ministry of Women and Child Development, "Coping Strategy for Children and Caregivers", 480884/2020/JS WCD, available at <https://wcd.nic.in/sites/default/files/FINAL%20COPING%20STRATEGY.pdf>

Checklists for Child Care Institutions under the JJ Act, 2015 for dealing with COVID-19⁸

A. Planning & Staff Reorganisation

1. **Update emergency contact list** of doctors, counsellors, NGOs, lawyers and other service providers.
2. Assess the staff strength available, identify the critical roles including health staff **and divide staff into batches** (25% - 50% in a batch) and instruct them to live within the CCI for one week at a time. Inform the DCPO in case of any shortage of such critical staff.
3. **Instruct staff off-duty to ensure** physical distancing, regular disinfection of hands & surfaces at home, reduce trips to shops, etc., to the bare minimum, in order to reduce their chances of infection and then inadvertently carrying the virus into the CCI.
4. **Consult healthcare providers** wherever possible for steps to be taken, for eg. whether children/staff need to be referred directly to a health facility, depending on the situation/context, or sent home, after obtaining the necessary orders from the concerned CWC/JJB/Children's Court.
5. Identify how to avail **transport** in case of any emergency in the CCI and inform all staff members.
6. Ensure **adequate supply** of food stock, drinking water, groceries, thermometer, disinfectants such as bleach, or alcohol based disinfectants, soap, menstrual hygiene products, protective clothing, quality face masks, etc., and other basic necessities. Identify suitable suppliers who can provide these items..
7. Ensure **adequate supply of medicines** and nutritional supplements such as zinc containing multivitamins and Vitamin C which could be given daily to children to reduce the chances of them catching the common cold. Recommended daily allowance for Vit C is 40 mg/ day, and 5-12 mg/day of Zinc for children from 1-18 years of age. Ensure supply of paracetamol and cetirizine in syrup and tablet form.
8. **Make quarantine arrangements.** Separate sick children and staff from those who are well, without creating stigma. Identify a room or space where children or staff who fall ill can be cared for, separate from those who are well.
9. **Keep a hospital bag ready** with material a child is likely to need, should the child need to be hospitalized, such as a change of clothes, toiletries and medicine, etc.
10. **Plan for recreation** by keeping adequate supplies of crayons, paints, clay, colouring books, arts and craft materials, activity books/sheets, etc., to help ensure children in the CCIs are engaged meaningfully. Speakers could be procured to play music inside the CCI, to support recreation, dance classes, etc.
11. Keep parents/caregivers, children, and staff **informed** about steps being taken.
12. **Utilize emergency/contingency funds** for the purpose of prevention and support for children being restored, and submit requisition for additional budgetary allocation where required.

B. Safety Precautions for Staff and Visitors

13. Encourage staff to **declare if they have come in contact with any person** who is suspected or confirmed to be COVID-19 positive or recently travelled from an area with community transmission [applies only to those areas that do not have current community transmission]. Such staff should not be permitted to enter the CCI.
14. Instruct staff/visitors to maintain **respiratory and hand hygiene**, including cutting nails short, maintaining at least 1 meter distance from residents, avoiding shaking hands/hugging the residents. Hand sanitizer with 70% alcohol must be kept at the entrance of the CCI. If sanitizer is not available, hands are to be washed with soap lather for 40 seconds as contact with soap destroys the virus.⁹ Encourage frequent usage of hand sanitizer or regular hand washing by guard, gardener, driver, etc., present in the CCI and that hands are cleaned and disinfected often, including on entry at the main door.
15. Advise children and staff to **cut their nails short**.
16. Ask staff/authorised persons to **inform and stay at home if they have fever or any respiratory illness**.

⁸ Based on the Supreme Court's direction in *In re Contagion of COVID 19 Virus in Children Protection Homes*, Suo Motu Writ Petition (Civil) No.4 of 2020).

⁹ UNESCO, *How Soap Kills COVID-19 on Hands*, <https://en.unesco.org/news/how-soap-kills-covid-19-hands>

- Follow up on staff with unexplained absences, to determine their health status.
17. Staff should **wear handmade reusable face cover** (if they are not suffering from medical conditions or have breathing difficulties)¹⁰ when they travel to and from the CCI and within the CCI, if they are commuting daily. Residents should wear such face covers when they step out in public places.
 18. Undertake **temperature check for all staff/authorized persons** at the entrance of the CCI daily. Ask any staff who is visibly ill to stop working and refer them to their health care provider.
 19. **Monitor staff and their contact with children**, especially contact with those children who have fever/respiratory symptoms
 20. **Restrict entry of visitors. Screen all visitors** and persons bringing goods and supplies for the CCI for signs and symptoms of acute respiratory infection, or fever. **Do not allow anyone with signs or symptoms of respiratory illness to enter the premises.**
 21. Avoid direct contact by visitors with any resident who is sick.
 22. Staff and visitors should **leave their footwear outside** as they may have stepped on spit containing cough/sneeze droplets.
 23. Consider setting up a **safe private space near the entrance for staff/visitors to change clothes**, if they are entering the CCI. Staff coming in daily to the CCI could keep a few sets of outer garments and shoes in the CCI and can change into them.
 24. When leaving the CCI, staff should **change outer garments, wash and keep them to dry in the CCI.**
 25. **Restrictions on entry of staff, organisations, and visitors should be reviewed from time to time** based on the guidelines issued by the government.

C. Ensuring Children's well-being

26. **Adhere to the fundamental principles on juvenile justice¹¹** and refer to the Illustrative Application of Fundamental Principles while responding to COVID-19.
27. **Facilitate children's regular contact with family and authorized service providers/ volunteers** through audio-visual means to maintain connection with the outside world and continuity of psycho-social support and learning. **Monitor these interactions** as well.
28. Try and ensure that **children being released, discharged or transferred are provided with rations (if it is likely that their families are in distress), copies of relevant documents, contact numbers of persons** they could call to seek any assistance, etc., and keep the DCPU informed, so as to prevent any harassment or distress during their journey.
29. Do not recommend discharge of a child unless you are confident that the child will be **safe during travel and upon restoration.**
30. **Initiate and support innovative programmes, online or through other mediums.**
31. **Proactively identify and organise** online/telephonic meetings with counselors, translators, interpreters, special educators, social workers, NGOs, mental health workers, vocational trainers etc., willing and able to conduct **distance mode services to children residing in CCIs.**
32. **Arrange wifi and other technical support** for authorized mental health workers, NGOs, teachers or others to facilitate distance mode interactive sessions with children.
33. **Seek support from civil society and community members** for arranging laptops and dongles, crayons, art-craft materials, etc, sanitize them, and make time to facilitate interactions.

D. Preventive Measures

34. **Conduct regular screening.** Early symptoms can include fever, cough and shortness of breath.
35. **Assess each child twice daily** for the development of a fever ($\geq 38^{\circ}\text{C}$ or 100.4°F), cough or shortness of breath. Keep the thermometers clean before and after use on every child.

¹⁰ Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, *Advisory on use of Handmade Protective Cover for Face and Mouth*, <https://www.mohfw.gov.in/pdf/Advisory&ManualonuseofHomemadeProtectiveCoverforFace&Mouth.pdf>

¹¹ Section 3, JJ Act, 2015.

36. **Follow procedures** established by the Ministry/Department of Health and Family Welfare, if children or staff or other service providers working in the CCI become unwell with symptoms of COVID-19.
37. **Inform the nurse/doctor attached to the CCI/CWC/JJB/Children's Court/DCPO** at the earliest, when there is a suspicion of COVID-19 infection in any staff/child. Call the helplines [1075 and 1800-112-545. For State and Union Territories Helpline numbers refer to <https://www.mohfw.gov.in/pdf/coronavirushelplinenumber.pdf>] or a local doctor for next steps.
38. **Quarantine** the child/staff's close contacts for 14 days and follow up for an additional 14 days or till the report of such case turns out negative on lab testing.
39. **Schedule regular hand washing reminders.**

Nutrition

40. Follow a **healthy and balanced diet** chart which is also to the liking of children.
41. **Do not deny children food they enjoy**, unless prohibited by their doctor. Good food gives children a sense of well-being and happiness.
42. Ensure children get adequate exposure to sunlight and a diet rich in vitamins and minerals. Several vitamins, including Vitamin D¹² have a direct link with a healthy immune system.

Physical Distancing

43. **Avoid shaking hands and hugging** as a matter of greeting. Instruct children and staff to maintain social distance by putting distance (at least 2 metres or 6 feet) between themselves.
44. **Reduce the number of people entering** into CCIs. Meetings should be done through video conferences and/or rescheduled.
45. Physical distancing should be **applied during reading, dining and watching television**. Use of these spaces can be scheduled at 25% participation and a schedule may be developed accordingly.

Cleaning and Disinfection Measures

46. If possible, make arrangements for **hand sanitizers that contain at least 70% alcohol**. Ensure that all surfaces of hands are covered, and they are rubbed together until they feel dry.
47. **Clean and disinfect** the CCI, especially water and sanitation facilities and surfaces that are touched by many people (like railings, doors, door and window handles, toys, light switches, desks, phones, teaching and learning aids etc.), at least once a day.
48. **Do not shake dirty laundry**; to minimize any dispersal of the virus through the air.
49. **Wash laundry using hot water** and with adequate amounts of soap/detergent, and dry them completely.
50. **Disinfect toilet surfaces daily** with regular household bleach solution/phenolic disinfectants.
51. **Maintain a clean and hygienic kitchen.**
52. **Increase airflow and ventilation** in the CCI to the extent possible.
53. **For disinfection**, common household disinfectants, diluted household bleach solutions/alcohol based disinfectants with at least 70% alcohol, should be used.
54. **Wear a mask** and do not touch your face during disinfecting. **Sanitize hands** after the activity.

E. Precautions when Receiving Supplies for the CCI

55. When **receiving supplies/ groceries/ other items for use in the CCI from a supplier**:
 - a) Instruct the persons responsible for delivering and receiving supplies to **wear a mask/face cover**.
 - b) Request the supplier to **leave the supplies outside at the entrance of the CCI** if possible. Avoid any physical contact with the supplier.
 - c) **Bring the supplies inside the CCI yourself**, and **avoid touching door handles** when doing so. If the supplies are such that the **container can be left unopened** for 1-3 days, do so. Disinfect hands and any surfaces you may have touched. Initial studies indicate that the virus may survive for upto 3 hours in

¹² C. Aranow, "Vitamin D and the immune system", Journal of investigative medicine : the official publication of the American Federation for Clinical Research, 59(6), (2011) 881–886. <https://doi.org/10.2310/JIM.0b013e31821b8755>

droplets in the air, upto 4 hours on copper, upto 24 hours on cardboard, and upto 3 days on stainless steel and plastic.¹³

- d) **Clean/disinfect all couriers, packages, parcels, grocery packets before bringing them inside** the CCI and sanitize hands right after the process. Preferably wear disposable gloves.
- e) If the container **has to be opened, identify where the contents will be kept and stored and keep these ready/ open**. Open the container, wash your hands, remove the supplies from the container, disinfect the contents as appropriate, and store the contents in the appropriate place.
- f) **Discard the container** in the dustbin, and wash/disinfect your hands thereafter.
- g) **If the supplier has to come inside the CCI** to deposit the container, instruct the person to leave footwear outside, then take the person straight to the location where the container has to be kept, making sure that you open the doors for the person carrying the container. Escort the person out of the CCI in the same manner, opening the doors for the person. Ensure minimal contact of the¹⁴ person with anyone else in the CCI, and any surfaces within the CCI. Wash your hands immediately.
- h) A **separate counter may be placed near the entrance of the CCI where donations** (in kind) can be accepted. Donors may be requested to provide dry ration/uncooked food material instead of cooked meal.

F. Quarantine Measures and Treatment Facilitation

Quarantine

“The quarantine of persons is the restriction of activities of or the separation of persons who are not ill but who may have been exposed to an infectious agent or disease, with the objective of monitoring their symptoms and ensuring the early detection of cases. Quarantine is different from isolation, which is the separation of ill or infected persons from others to prevent the spread of infection or contamination.”

Source: WHO, *Considerations for quarantine of individuals in the context of containment for coronavirus disease (COVID-19), Interim guidance*, 19 March 2020.¹⁵

56. Have a **quarantine/segregated section**, where possible, or make alternate arrangements.
57. Place children being newly admitted in a **Reception Centre** for 14 days as per Rule 69F(2), JJ Model Rules, 2016. If the child is asymptomatic, this will prevent the transmission of COVID-19. Consider following the guidelines for care of children who may be exposed to COVID-19 in section G below, while also taking into account relevant circulars by the State Government, if any.
58. **Shift children who display the onset of symptoms** like fever, cough, weakness, loss of appetite, shortness of breath, sputum production, body ache, etc., to the Sick Room or First Aid Room.
59. **Contact the doctor** attached to the CCI/nearest health centre/COVID Helpline and seek advice.
60. **Promptly facilitate child/staff's testing for COVID-19** based on medical advice received. List of Government approved Laboratories has been provided by the Indian Council of Medical Research.¹⁶
61. Follow the **SOP for transportation of a suspected/confirmed case of COVID-19** issued by the Ministry

¹³ Harvard Health Publishing, “COVID-19 basics Symptoms, spread and other essential information about the new coronavirus and COVID-19”, Harvard Medical School, March 2020, <https://www.health.harvard.edu/diseases-and-conditions/covid-19-basics>; Alex W H Chin, et.al., “Stability of SARS-CoV-2 in different environmental conditions”, The Lancet, 02.04.20, [https://www.thelancet.com/journals/lanmic/article/PIIS2666-5247\(20\)30003-3/fulltext](https://www.thelancet.com/journals/lanmic/article/PIIS2666-5247(20)30003-3/fulltext); National Institutes of Health, “New coronavirus stable for hours on surfaces”, 17.03.20, available at <https://www.nih.gov/news-events/news-releases/new-coronavirus-stable-hours-surfaces>

¹⁴ NCPDR, *Advisory regarding care and protection of children moving with migrant families; children living on streets/Child Care Institutions in light of COVID-19*, 29 March 2020.

¹⁵ Available at [https://www.who.int/publications-detail/considerations-for-quarantine-of-individuals-in-the-context-of-containment-for-coronavirus-disease-\(covid-19\)](https://www.who.int/publications-detail/considerations-for-quarantine-of-individuals-in-the-context-of-containment-for-coronavirus-disease-(covid-19))

¹⁶ Available at https://icmr.nic.in/sites/default/files/upload_documents/COVID_19_Testing_Laboratories.pdf

of Health and Family Welfare, Government of India.¹⁷

62. **Immediately inform parents/guardians, JJB/CWC/Children's Courts if the COVID-19 test is positive.**
63. The person who is showing symptoms and the people caring for them should wear a mask. The WHO provides the following **guidance regarding masks**:¹⁸
 - Before putting on a mask, clean hands with alcohol-based hand rub or soap and water.
 - Cover mouth and nose with a mask and ensure there are no gaps between face and mask.
 - Avoid touching the mask while using it; if you do, disinfect your hands with alcohol-based hand rub or soap and water.
 - Replace the mask with a new one as soon as it is damp and do not reuse single-use masks.
 - To remove the mask: remove it from behind (do not touch the front of the mask); discard immediately in a closed bin; clean hands with alcohol-based hand rub or soap and water.

Please also refer to the advisory on **home-made protective cover for face and mouth** by the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, Government of India, available at

<https://www.mohfw.gov.in/pdf/Advisory&ManualonuseofHomemadeProtectiveCoverforFace&Mouth.pdf>

G. Care for Children in CCIs who may have been exposed to COVID-19¹⁹

64. **Take time to help these children to understand the situation, and ensure that they are provided the psycho-social support to deal with the same.**
65. Care for these children in a **well-ventilated room preferably with an attached/separate toilet**. If more than one child needs to stay in the same room, **maintain a distance of at least 1 metre** between them.
66. The person who is **showing symptoms and the people caring for them should wear a mask** (see point 63).
67. **Ensure that children are not made to feel they have been isolated because of their identity, or because they are being punished.**
68. **Restrict the movement** of these children within the CCI, especially contact with elderly people, pregnant girls or women, children and persons with co-morbidities (eg., asthma, diabetes, heart disease, etc.).
69. Ensure that the children **wash their hands often or use an alcohol-based hand sanitizer**.
70. **Ensure that household items, e.g. dishes, plates, towels, bedding, or other items are not shared** with others.
71. Only **assigned staff members should care for these children**.
72. **Visitors should not be allowed into this section** of the CCI.

Environmental Sanitation

73. Preferably **use disposable gloves when cleaning surfaces or handling soiled linen**. Clean and disinfect frequently touched surfaces in the quarantined person's room (e.g. bed frames, tables, etc.), daily with 1% Sodium Hypochlorite solution.
74. **Clean and disinfect toilet surfaces daily** with household bleach solution/phenolic disinfectants.
75. **Clean the clothes and other linen used by these children/staff separately** using common household detergent and dry them well. Avoid shaking the soiled linen or direct contact with skin.
76. **Wash hands after removing gloves.**

¹⁷ Available at

<https://www.mohfw.gov.in/pdf/StandardOperatingProcedureSOPfortransportingasuspectorconfirmedcaseofCOVID19.pdf>

¹⁸ World Health Organization, *Coronavirus disease (COVID-19) advice for the public: When and how to use masks*, downloaded on 8 April 2020, available at <https://www.who.int/emergencies/diseases/novel-coronavirus-2019/advice-for-public/when-and-how-to-use-masks>

¹⁹ Based on Ministry of Health and Family Welfare Directorate General of Health Services [Emergency Medical Relief], Guidelines for Home Quarantine, <https://www.mohfw.gov.in/DraftGuidelinesforhomequarantine.pdf>

The Health Ministry has set up a National Helpline on COVID-19, which is 1075 and 1800-112-545. In case of any queries or clarifications related to Coronavirus pandemic, call on this number. In addition, Childline 1098 continues to be operational. State and Union Territories Helpline numbers are available at <https://www.mohfw.gov.in/pdf/coronavirushelplinenumber.pdf>

Information on COVID-19

COVID-19 is a respiratory illness that generally presents with fever, cough and shortness of breath. There is currently no vaccine to prevent COVID --19. The best way to prevent illness is to avoid being exposed to this virus. Current understanding of the way the virus spreads is as follows:

- Between a person who is infected with the virus and other people who are in close contact with that person, (within about 6 feet);
- Having face -to -face contact with a COVID--19 patient within 2 meters (6 feet);²⁰
- Through respiratory droplets produced when an infected person coughs or sneezes. These droplets can land in the mouths or noses of people who are nearby or possibly be inhaled into the lungs (within about one metre / 3 feet);
- Transmission of the virus is the most when a person is sick, with symptoms like cough, running nose, etc. However, some transmission can also occur even when the person is not showing any symptoms;
- If a person comes in contact with a surface or object (like a table, vessel, packet) that has the virus on it, and then touches their mouth or nose or eyes. Contact with contaminated surfaces or objects is not thought to be the main way the virus spreads.²¹

Symptoms of COVID-19

The symptoms²² of COVID-19 are similar in children and adults and include:

(1) Cold-like symptoms such as runny nose and sore throat (2) Fever (above 38°C or 100.4 °F) (3) Cough (4) Body pain (5) Diarrhoea and vomiting. The symptoms of COVID-19 infection are similar to the flu (influenza), and the common cold, which are a lot more common than COVID-19. This is why testing is required to confirm if someone has COVID-19.²³ When any or all of 1-5 symptoms are present, check for high contact conditions below

Red Flag Signs: These are warning symptoms/signs, that require immediate medical attention

1. Difficulty breathing or shortness of breath after symptoms set in;
2. Tightness in chest or chest pain after symptoms set in;

²⁰ The reference to 15 minutes in the Supreme Court's order dated 03.04.20 has been deleted as "the 15-minute limit is arbitrarily selected for practical purposes. Based on individual risk assessments, public health authorities may consider expanding contact tracing and management to persons who had a shorter duration of contact with a case." See European Center for Disease Prevention and Control, "Contact tracing: Public health management of persons, including healthcare workers, having had contact with COVID-19 cases in the European Union," 25 February 2020.

<https://www.ecdc.europa.eu/sites/default/files/documents/covid-19-public-health-management-contact-novel-coronavirus-cases-EU.pdf>

²¹ Center for Disease Control and Prevention, "How Coronavirus Spreads", <https://www.cdc.gov/coronavirus/2019-ncov/prevent-getting-sick/how-covid-spreads.html>

²² Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, "Symptoms of Coronavirus", <https://www.cdc.gov/coronavirus/2019-ncov/symptoms-testing/symptoms.html>

²³ UNICEF & WHO, *Key Messages and Actions for COVID-19 Prevention and Control in Schools*, March 2020, p.3, https://www.who.int/docs/default-source/coronaviruse/key-messages-and-actions-for-covid-19-prevention-and-control-in-schools-march-2020.pdf?sfvrsn=baf81d52_4

3. New onset confusion or difficulty in waking up; and
4. Bluish lips or face.

What to do if a person develop symptoms suggestive of COVID-19 infection: If the child/staff has any of the symptoms mentioned above with one of the high contact risk factors, the child/staff has a high risk of COVID-19 infection and should be referred to the nearest PHC/COVID-19 testing and managing hospitals. Immediately notify the JJB/CWC/Children's Court, DCPU, and the local health department.

Core Messages on COVID-19 for Children in Child Care Institutions under the JJ Act, 2015

Inform, talk about COVID-19

- Keep the age, maturity and any disability of the child in mind when talking to them.
- Ask children what they have heard about the COVID-19 virus, so that you better understand their thoughts, beliefs and fears.
- Explain that COVID-19 is a new virus (germ) that causes infection of the nose, throat and lungs. It is similar to the viruses that cause the common cold and the flu.
- The virus enters through the nose, mouth or eyes. It makes the person cough, sneeze, have a running nose and fever. It can infect the lungs and cause problems with breathing. Some people get loose motions and vomiting. For some people the symptoms are very mild, whereas for others it could require hospitalization.
- Avoid using words like 'terrible', 'horrible,' etc., when describing the virus.
- Avoid providing excessive information or talking about COVID-19 repeatedly.

Reassure, allay fears/ anxiety

- Explain the reasons for restriction of entry of family/guardian/ lawyers/service providers - the virus is easily transmitted from person to person
- Explain that in children and young people the infection seems to be mild.
- Talk about how the vast majority of people who get COVID-19 infection, recover. In fact, 80% of those infected don't even need to be admitted in a hospital. A scientific study showed that severe infection among children is rare. 99.4% of children had mild or moderate symptoms.²⁴
- Avoid causing fear, stigma, hopelessness, panic or the opposite - complacency.

Share and explain factual and scientific information from verified sources, including:

- The virus **spreads easily** from an infected person to another. The virus is present in the discharge that comes out when a person who is infected coughs or sneezes or spits.
- **Close contact** with a person who has COVID-19 can also transfer the infection.
- The virus can also **survive for several hours to days** on things touched by a person who has COVID-19 infection.
- A person **can get the virus** on to their hands by touching surfaces or objects that have the virus on them, and then touching their mouth, nose or eyes.
- The virus **cannot enter the body through the skin**.
- The virus **can be easily destroyed if it comes in contact with soap, detergents and commonly available disinfectants**.
- Since the virus is new, there is **no vaccine** against the virus at present.
- There is **no 100% effective treatment either, as yet**. Different medicines are being used to treat patients with fairly good results.

Build agency and encourage children to participate actively in protecting themselves and others while preventing the spread of COVID-19

- **Ask children how they can protect themselves and others, and how they could contribute to keeping the CCI clean and free from the COVID-19 virus?**

²⁴ Ian P Sinha, Rachel Harwood, Malcolm G Semple, Daniel B Hawcutt, Rebecca Thursfield, Omendra Narayan, et al. Published: March 27, 2020 DOI :[https://doi.org/10.1016/S2213-2600\(20\)30152-1](https://doi.org/10.1016/S2213-2600(20)30152-1)The Lancet Respiratory Medicine, COVID-19 infection in children, [https://www.thelancet.com/journals/lanres/article/PIIS2213-2600\(20\)30152-1/fulltext](https://www.thelancet.com/journals/lanres/article/PIIS2213-2600(20)30152-1/fulltext)

- Explain that this can be done by:
 1. **Keeping hands clean:** Wash hands often, every two hours if possible, and after blowing one's nose, coughing, or sneezing,²⁵ after using the toilet, before & after preparing food, before eating and when hands are soiled. Cut nails short.
 2. **Disinfecting properly:** Wash with soap and water for at least 40 seconds or disinfecting with a hand sanitizer for a minimum of 20 seconds. Explain that soap acts by breaking down the outer layer of the virus, so it is important to lather for 40 minutes.
 1. **Avoiding touching the face, mouth, nose and eyes:** Touching with unsanitized hands can cause infection, as the virus may be on our hands after having touched something that has the virus;
 2. **Giving instructions on coughing/sneezing:** Cover mouth and nose with the elbow when coughing/ sneezing and sanitize hands immediately afterwards, to protect self and others;
 3. **Wearing a mask if sick with cough and cold** to protect others; and if one is caring for a sick person.
 4. **Giving instructions on safe disposal of waste:** Waste material to be disposed of in a bin lined with a disposable bag, and with a lid.
 5. **Ensuring Physical distancing:** Maintain a distance of 1 meter or 3 feet from staff/visitors/service providers who come in from outside. Also avoid being within 3 feet or too close to a person who is coughing/sneezing.

Guidelines for Conducting Online Activities and Sessions with Children/Staff of Child Care Institutions

1. Ensure that a **staff is present** during the session and the **children are not unsupervised**.
2. Ensure privacy and confidentiality. No session should be recorded in any format or pictures of the children taken and circulated.
3. **Plan for or conduct activities that help to build a sense of community and positive relationships**, those that are likely to help children and the CCI staff to cope better with the circumstances they are currently in, given the COVID-19 pandemic.
4. **Inform CCI staff in advance** about the contents of the online session.
5. Identify an **adult in the CCI who could support the children emotionally or in other ways**, if any exigencies arise during or after the session.
6. **Avoid conducting activities, or including content that is likely to exacerbate anxiety or distress related to COVID-19**. If such conversations do arise, try to be positive and speak the language of fact based possibilities, as appropriate.
7. Design sessions that enable all children to **participate meaningfully, bearing in mind language, age, disability, and limits of human resources etc., to the extent possible**.
8. **Do not exclude any child from online sessions, unless there are valid reasons for the same**. Discuss this with the other CCI staff, and keep a record of such situations.
9. **Do not conduct sessions that have more than a certain number of children participating**, to the extent that the online interactive experience becomes meaningless.
10. Try to **include physical activities, music, games, art and craft and other mediums** to work with the children during these online sessions. Be prepared to adapt based on the situation, time available, and connectivity issues.
11. Plan and **conduct short sessions (even 10 minutes) with staff**, to the extent that such sessions are possible, **to affirm the staff who are working on the frontline**, to motivate and boost their morale.

²⁵ World Health Organization, *Basic protection measures against the new coronavirus*, available at <https://www.who.int/emergencies/diseases/novel-coronavirus-2019/advice-for-public>

12. **Advise and encourage CCI staff and health-care personnel to practice self-care**, to stay connected with loved ones and to access mental health and psychosocial support, particularly given that they may themselves be at risk of stigmatization and social exclusion arising out of fears of COVID-19.
13. **Avoid criticizing or blaming any staff for lacunae in managing the CCIs during this time.**
14. If you **observe a staff member causing harm to a child during the session, take note of it and handle that situation sensitively.** Bring to the **attention of the Person in Charge of the CCI**, should you have any **concern about children being at risk of harm, or being harmed** in the CCI.

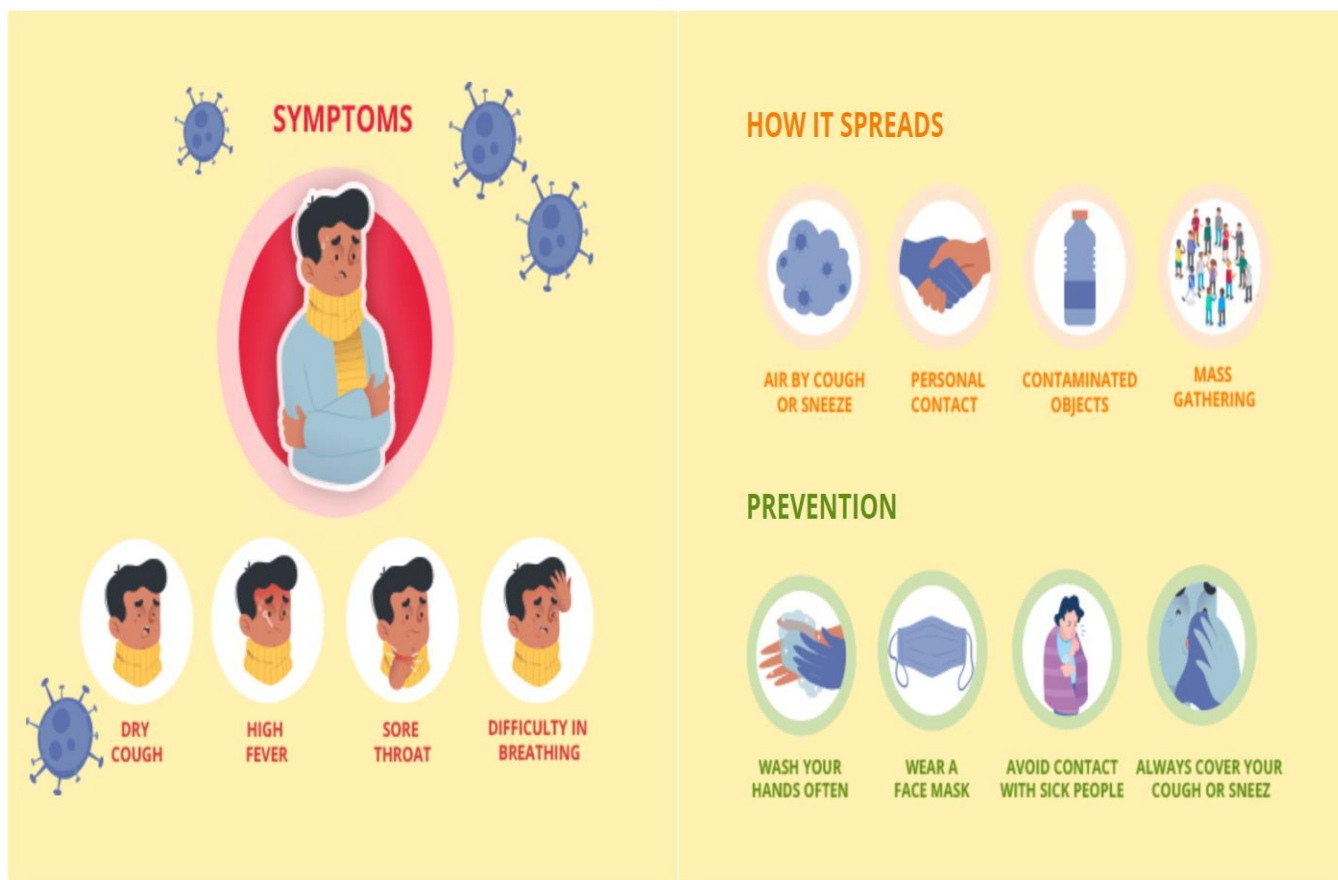
Checklist to enable effective advance planning related to technical and other physical arrangements required for the ONLINE audio-visual interaction

1. Laptop/desktop with a web camera
2. A stable internet connection - either a LAN cable or Wifi or a Dongle
3. Speakers with a microphone (if you want to talk to a large more number of children)
4. Electrical connection and availability of electricity during at the time of the planned activity.
5. Whether the room being used for the online interaction is suitable for the activity you have planned, bearing in mind the technical issues that may come up, such as availability of electrical connection, adequate light to enable visibility, etc.
6. Whether the CCI staff supporting you in conducting the session is familiar with the technical aspects of the audio-video call. If not, spend some time with the person prior to the call in order to give necessary instructions, and to allay any fears the person may have.
7. Availability of the materials you would need for the proposed activity.

Posters that may be displayed in CCIs

(1) Government of India's Poster on 'COVID-19 Spread and Signs and Symptoms'

Source: <https://www.mygov.in/covid-19/>



2) The Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, Government of India's Poster on 'Protect yourself and others - Do's and Don'ts'

Source: https://www.mohfw.gov.in/pdf/Poster_Corona_ad_Eng.pdf



Ministry of Health & Family Welfare
Government of India

Help us to help you

NOVEL CORONAVIRUS (COVID-19)



Protect yourself and others!
Follow these **Do's** and **Don'ts**

Do's ✓

-  Practice frequent hand washing. Wash hands with soap and water or use alcohol based hand rub. Wash hands even if they are visibly clean
-  Cover your nose and mouth with handkerchief/tissue while sneezing and coughing
-  Throw used tissues into closed bins immediately after use
-  See a doctor if you feel unwell (fever, difficult breathing and cough). While visiting doctor wear a mask/cloth to cover your mouth and nose
-  If you have these signs/symptoms please call State helpline number or Ministry of Health & Family Welfare's 24X7 helpline at 011-23978046
-  Avoid participating in large gatherings

Don'ts ✗

-  Have a close contact with anyone, if you're experiencing cough and fever
-  Touch your eyes, nose and mouth
-  Spit in public

Together we can fight Coronavirus

For further information :
Call at Ministry of Health, Govt. of India's 24X7 control room number
+91-11-2397 8046
Email at ncov2019@gmail.com

 mohfw.gov.in  [@MoHFWIndia](https://www.facebook.com/MoHFWIndia)  [@MoHFW_INDIA](https://twitter.com/MoHFW_INDIA)  [mohfwindia](https://www.youtube.com/mohfwindia)

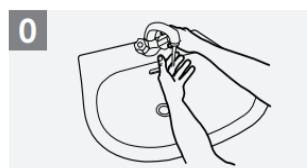
(3) The World Health Organization's Poster on 'Handwashing'

Source: https://www.who.int/gpsc/5may/How_To_HandWash_Poster.pdf?ua=1

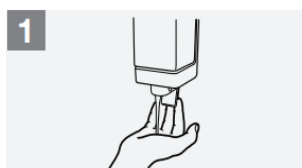
How to Handwash?

WASH HANDS WHEN VISIBLY SOILED! OTHERWISE, USE HANDRUB

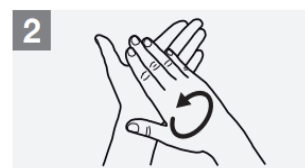
 **Duration of the entire procedure: 40-60 seconds**



Wet hands with water;



Apply enough soap to cover all hand surfaces;



Rub hands palm to palm;



Right palm over left dorsum with interlaced fingers and vice versa;



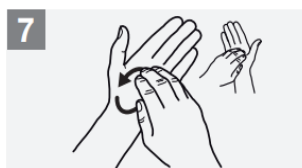
Palm to palm with fingers interlaced;



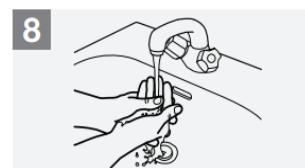
Backs of fingers to opposing palms with fingers interlocked;



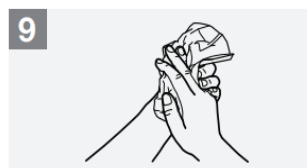
Rotational rubbing of left thumb clasped in right palm and vice versa;



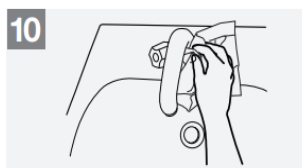
Rotational rubbing, backwards and forwards with clasped fingers of right hand in left palm and vice versa;



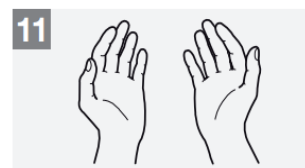
Rinse hands with water;



Dry hands thoroughly with a single use towel;



Use towel to turn off faucet;



Your hands are now safe.



World Health Organization

Patient Safety

A World Alliance for Safer Health Care

SAVE LIVES

Clean Your Hands

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May 2009

(4) World Health Organization's poster on

'Helping children cope with stress during the 2019 n-Cov outbreak'

Source: [Helping children cope with stress during the 2019-nCoV outbreak](#)



World Health Organization

Helping children cope with stress during the 2019-nCoV outbreak



Children may respond to stress in different ways such as being more clingy, anxious, withdrawing, angry or agitated, bedwetting etc.

Respond to your child's reactions in a supportive way, listen to their concerns and give them extra love and attention.

Children need adults' love and attention during difficult times. Give them extra time and attention.

Remember to listen to your children, speak kindly and reassure them.

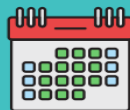
If possible, make opportunities for the child to play and relax.





Try and keep children close to their parents and family and avoid separating children and their caregivers to the extent possible. If separation occurs (e.g. hospitalization) ensure regular contact (e.g. via phone) and re-assurance.

Keep to regular routines and schedules as much as possible, or help create new ones in a new environment, including school/learning as well as time for safely playing and relaxing.





Provide facts about what has happened, explain what is going on now and give them clear information about how to reduce their risk of being infected by the disease in words that they can understand depending on their age.

This also includes providing information about what could happen in a re-assuring way (e.g. a family member and/or the child may start not feeling well and may have to go to the hospital for some time so doctors can help them feel better).

5) The World Health Organization's Poster on

'Coping with stress during the 2019-nCoV outbreak'

Source: https://www.who.int/docs/default-source/coronaviruse/coping-with-stress.pdf?sfvrsn=9845bc3a_2

